



All smiles: India settled for a bronze in the team event after its dream run ended with a defeat to Indonesia in the semifinal. PTI

both the boys' and girls' doubles titles, reaffirming its might as badminton's Asian powerhouse.

Rigorous regimen pays off

The Guwahati facility, where Tanvi and 47 other shuttlers currently train, houses 16 courts, a 4,000 sq ft gymnasium equipped with modern fitness tools, a 60-bed hostel and a 2,000 sq ft physiotherapy centre.

Every night, after 9.30 p.m., the players' mobile phones are collected by the hostel warden. "The warden has the parents' contacts. If there's any emergency, players can call them; otherwise, the phone will be a distraction," said Mishra.

Even players from Guwahati must stay in the hostel. No one is allowed to order food from outside, and outings are permitted just once a week.

The idea behind these measures is to micro-manage the players' development — from sleep cycles and diet to recovery after training. "Our next plan is to increase the capacity to 100 so that we can focus on more players," Mishra added.

A significant stepping stone

What does it mean to be a Junior World Champion? The answer differs across generations.

Some shuttlers develop rapidly and do not need a junior title to propel them at the senior level. Saina's 2008 triumph came just three months after she had already reached the Olympic quarterfinals in Beijing. On the other hand, Thailand's Kunlavut Vitidsarn, a three-time Junior World Champion (2017-19), won his first major senior medal — a silver — at the 2022 Senior World Championships before clinching gold a year later.

For others, the transition proves more challenging, and their success at the Junior Worlds remains the defining moment of their career.

Honour board

Mixed Team:

Gold: China, Silver: Indonesia, Bronze: India & Japan

Girls' Singles:

Gold: Anyapat Pichitpreechasak (Tha), Silver: Tanvi Sharma, Bronze: Liu Si Ya (China) & Yataweemin Ketklieng (Tha)

Boys' Singles:

Gold: Liu Yang Ming Yu (Chn), Silver: Mohd. Zaki Ubaidillah (Ina), Bronze: Li Zhi Hang (Chn) & Richie Duta Richardo (Ina)

Mixed Doubles:

Gold: Lee Hyeong Woo & Cheon Hye In (Kor), Silver: Hung Bing Fu & Chou Yun An (Tpe), Bronze: Chen Jun Ting & Cao Zi Han (Chn), Loh Ziheng & Noraqilah Maisarah (Mas)

Girls' Doubles:

Gold: Tan Ke Xuan & Yue Yue Wei (Chn), Silver: Zi Yu Low & Noraqilah Maisarah (Mas), Bronze: Kodchaporn Chaichana & Pannawee Polyiam (Tha), Cao Zi Han & Chen Fan Shu Tian (Chn)

Boys' Doubles:

Gold: Chen Jun Ting & Liu Jun Rong (Chn), Silver: Cho Hyeong Woo & Lee Hyeong Woo (Kor), Bronze: Kazuma Kawano & Shuji Sawada (Jpn), Alexius Ongkytama Subagio & Aquino Evano Keneddy Tangka (Ina)